



An Roinn Dlí agus Cirt,  
Gnóthaí Baile agus Imirce  
Department of Justice,  
Home Affairs and Migration

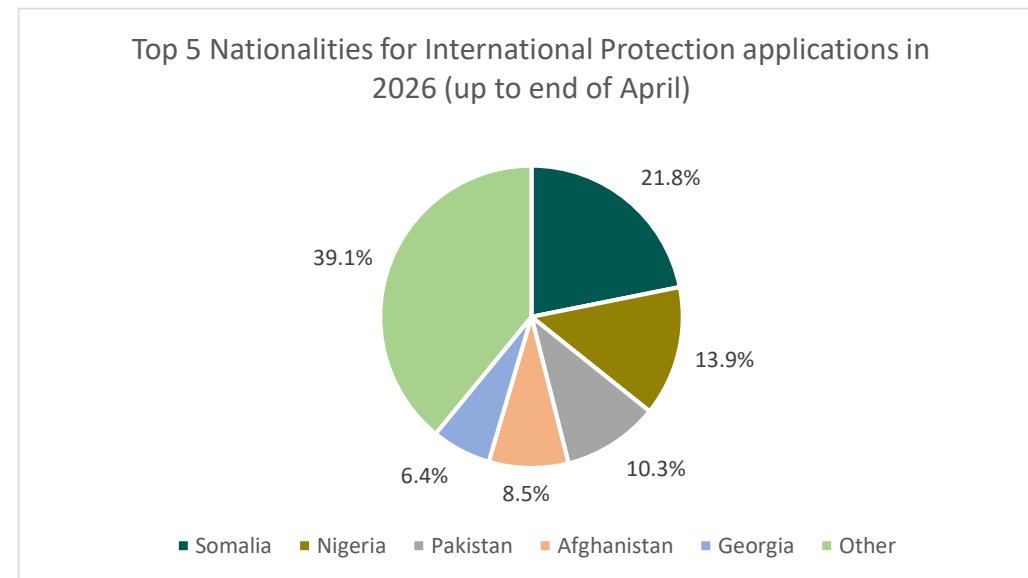
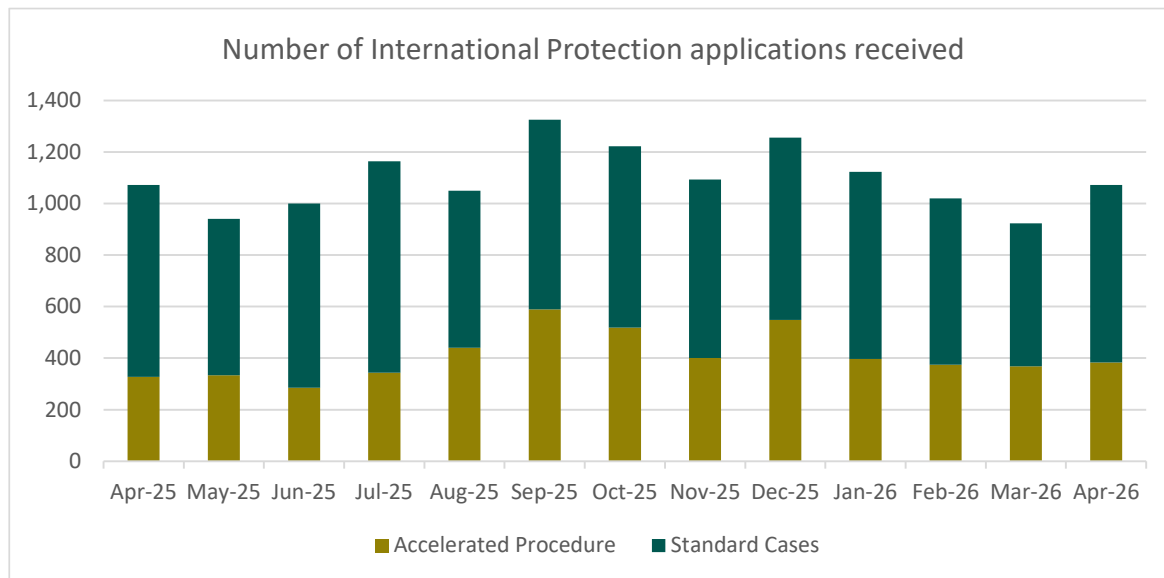
# International Protection: April 2026

# Executive Summary

The figures in this dashboard were extracted on the 5<sup>th</sup> May 2026. These are operational figures and subject to change. The charts below refer to key points in the asylum process. A flow chart is provided at the end of the pack that sets out this process. Overall, for April 2026:

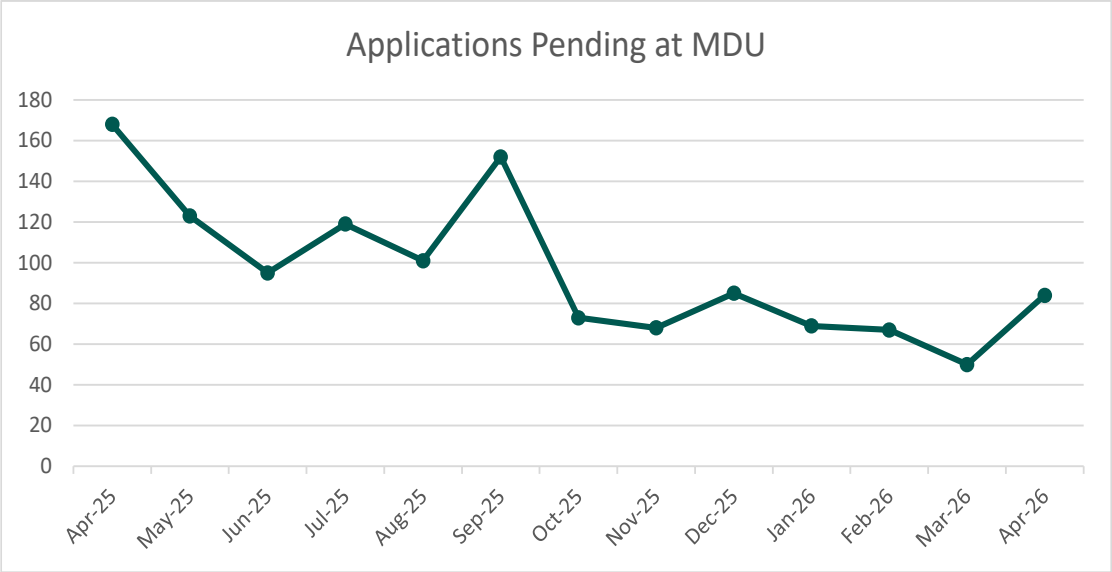
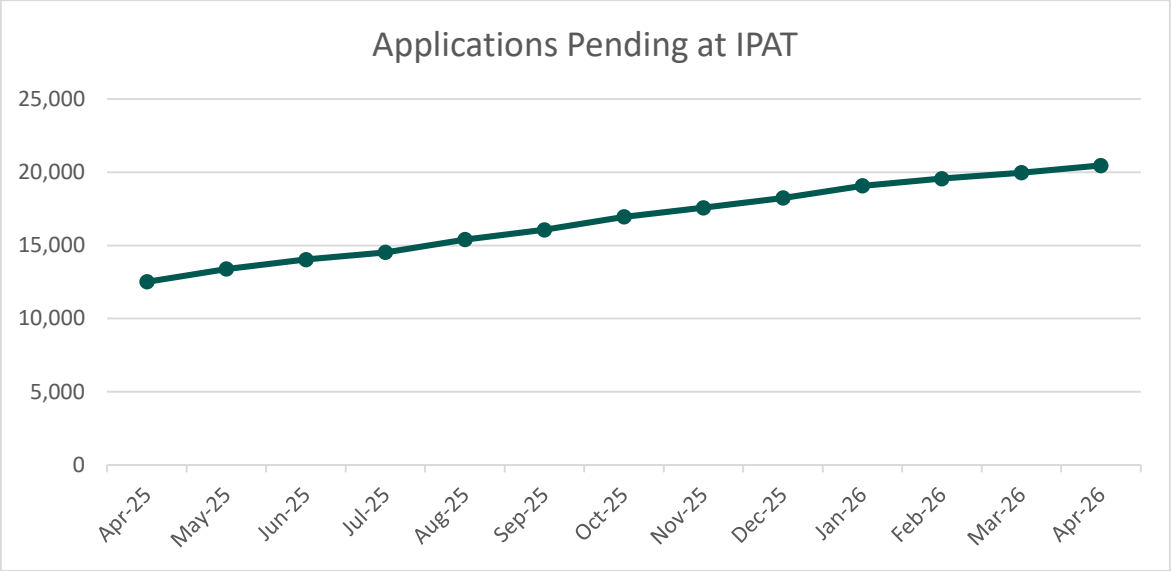
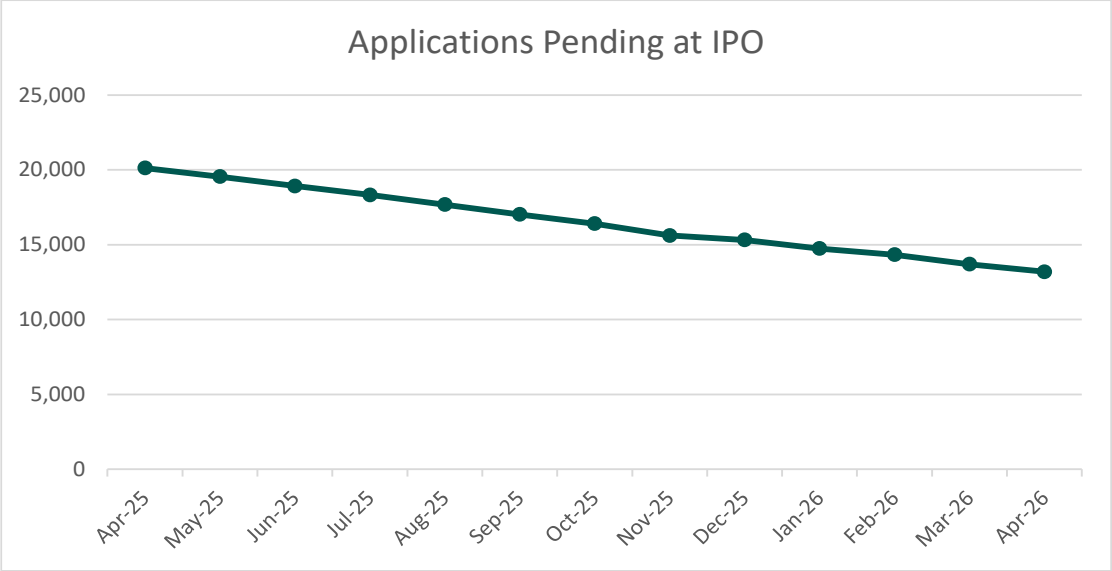
- As of April this year, the number of asylum applications has risen slightly compared to last year. In April 2026 there were 1,072 applications compared to 1,073 in April 2025
- The main countries of origin for 2026 are: Somalia (904 applications), Nigeria (575), Pakistan (427), Afghanistan (352) and Georgia (263)
- The number of applications pending in the IPO has been reducing since the end of September 2024, when it stood at 23,863. As of April this year, there were 13,194 applications pending
- Compared to last year, there has been a slight increase in the number of applications where the IPO made a recommendation or otherwise closed off a case. In April 2026, 1,610 cases were closed off compared to 1,594 in April 2025
- The median time to make a decision for standard cases has decreased slightly. In April 2026, the median processing time to determination was 65 weeks (compared to 76 weeks in October 2025 and 75 weeks in January 2026)
- The number of staff in the IPO has decreased slightly to 612 at the end of April 2026
- Of those applications where a final decision was made in April 2026 (for example, after the outcomes of appeals were considered), 53% of decisions were refusals, 0% permission to remain, and 47% were international protection grants

# Applications and Main Nationalities



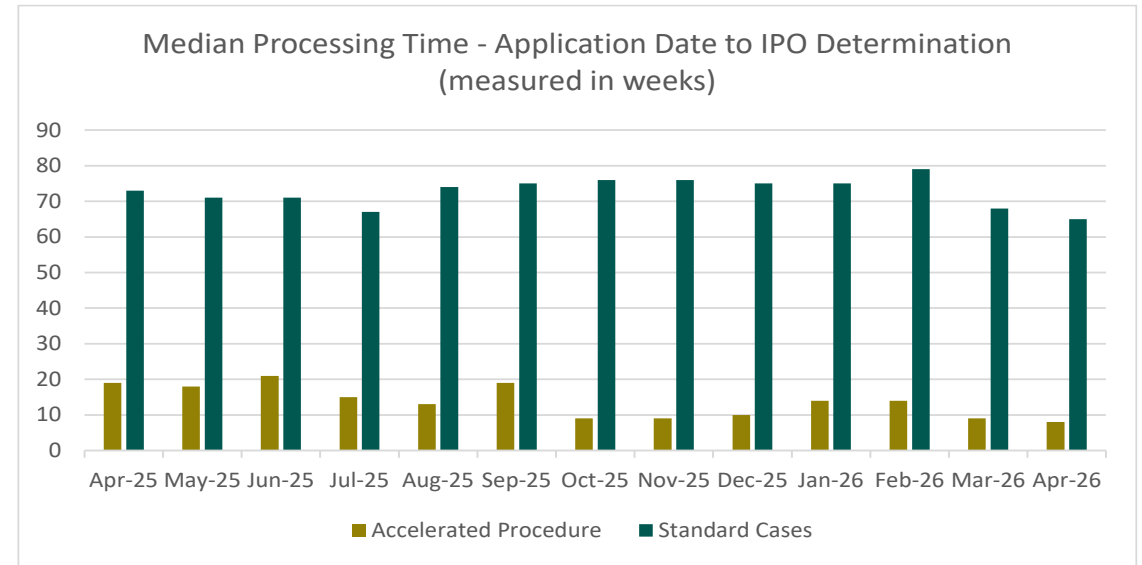
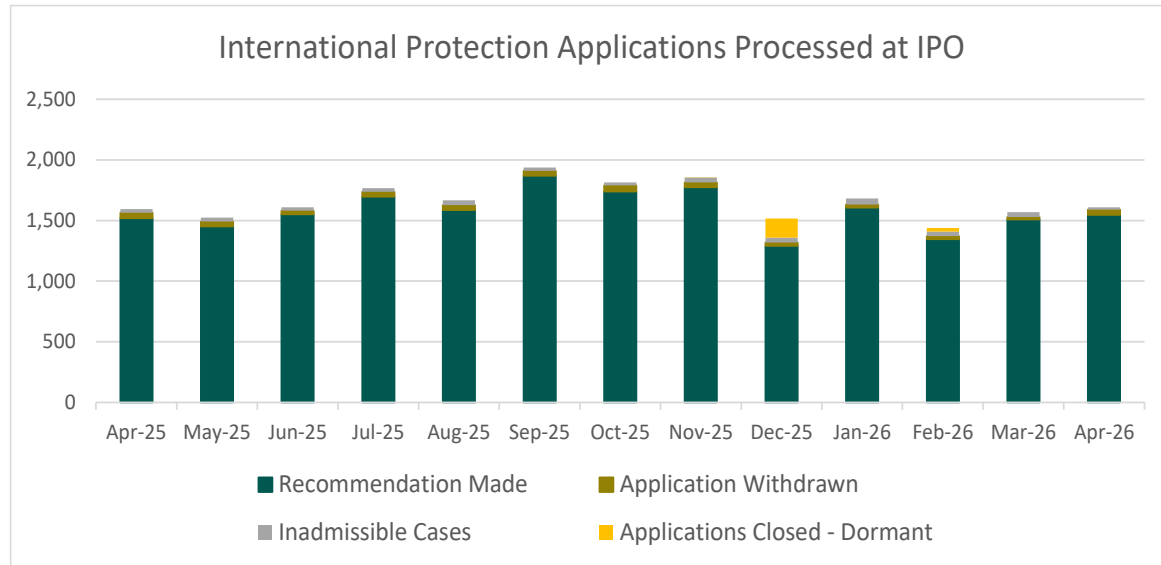
- In April 2026 there were 1,072 applications received for asylum. This is down from 1,073 last March
- The total number of applications in April 2026 that fell under accelerated procedure was 383 (which represents 36% of all applicants)
- The main countries of origin for 2026 are: Somalia (904 applications), Nigeria (575), Pakistan (427), Afghanistan (352) and Georgia (263)

# Pending International Protection Applications



- The number of applications pending in the IPO is 13,194. The numbers have been reducing since the end of September 2024
- The number of pending applications for IPAT has been trending upwards. In April 2026, there were 20,469 applications pending
- The pending figure for MDU at the end of April 2026 is 84

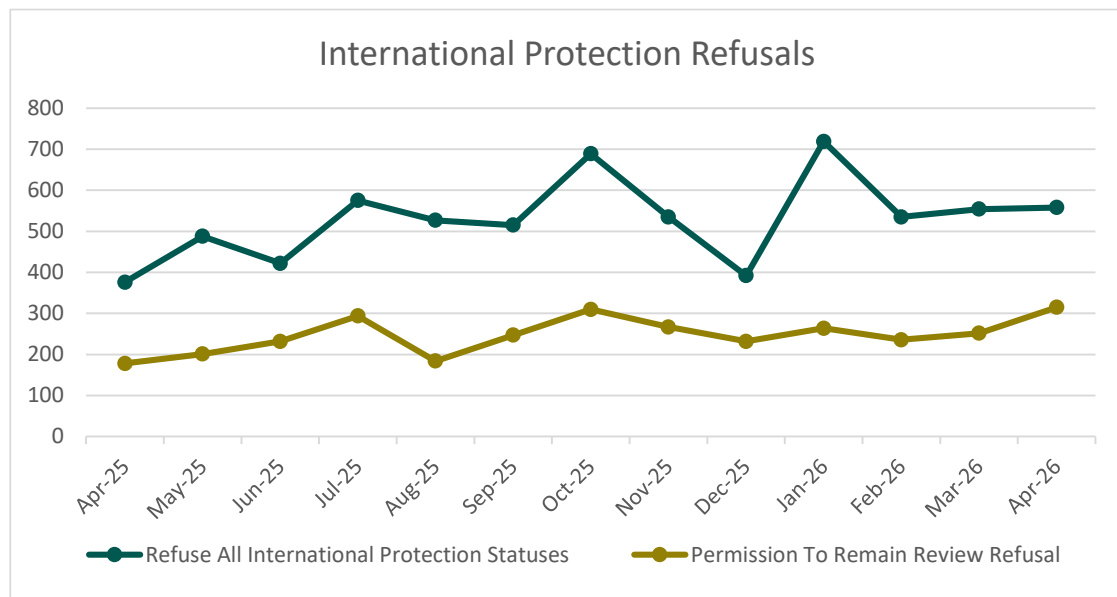
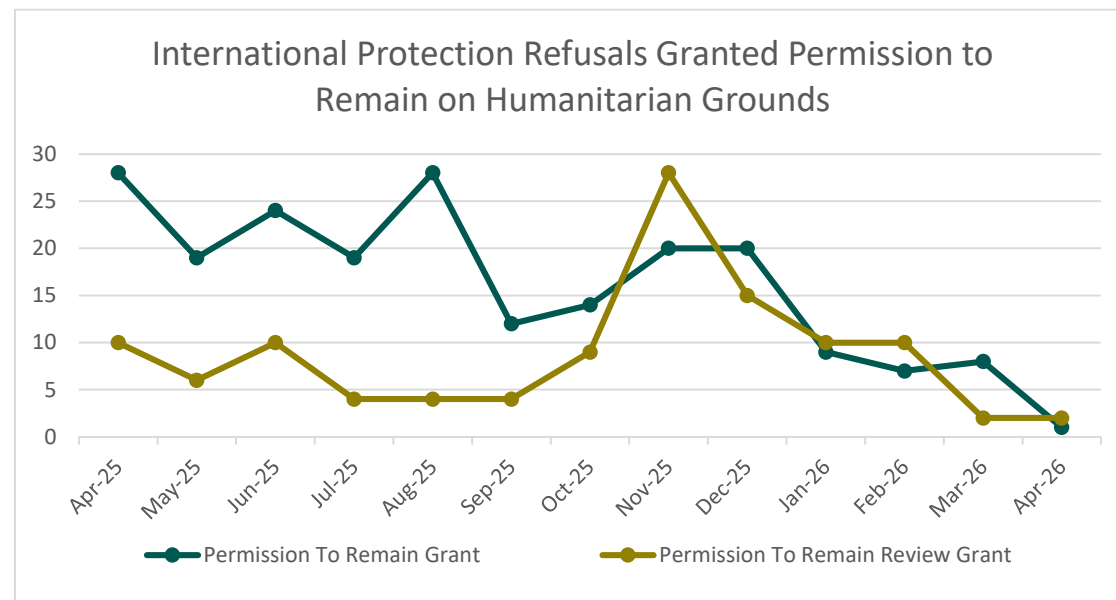
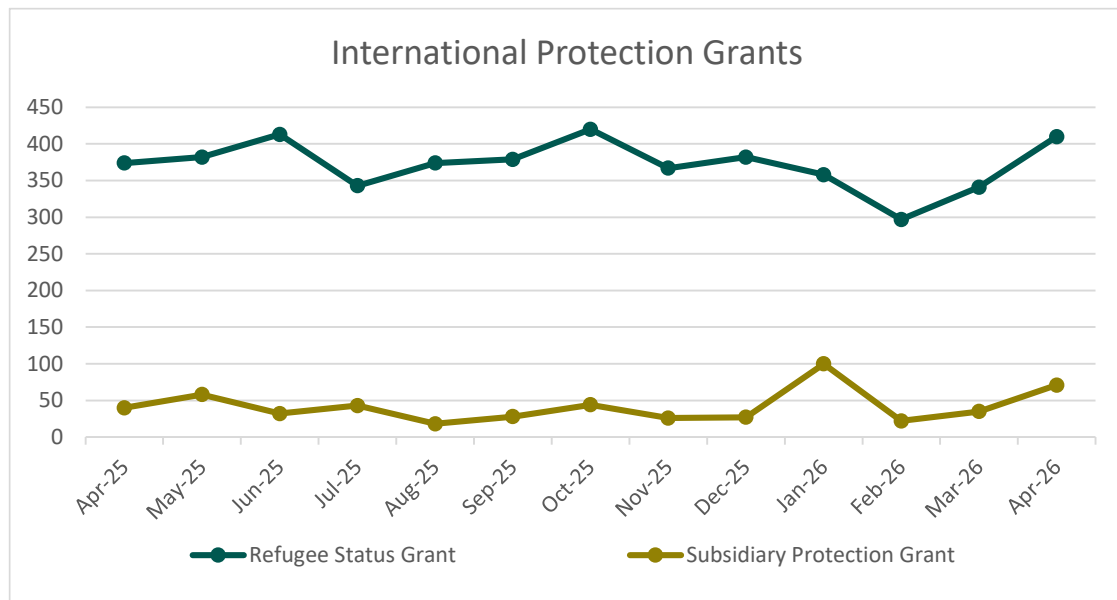
# International Protection: Applications Processed and Median Processing Time



- This table is counting Recommendations Made, Applications Deemed Inadmissible, Applications Withdrawn and Dormant Applications
- In April 2026, 1,610 cases were closed off. This is up from 1,439 in February and 1,570 in March
- 2026 YTD applications processed were 6,300 (a 3.5% decrease on 6,528 applications processed for 2025)

- The median processing time to determining an outcome to an asylum application had been remaining steady for Standard Cases. The median processing time for cases under the Accelerated Procedure have decreased compared to the first half of 2025.
- In April 2026, the median processing time to determination for standard cases was 65 weeks (down from 76 weeks in October 2025 and 75 weeks in January 2026)
- For accelerated procedure only, the median processing time was 8 weeks in April 2026, down from 14 weeks in February and 9 weeks in March 2026

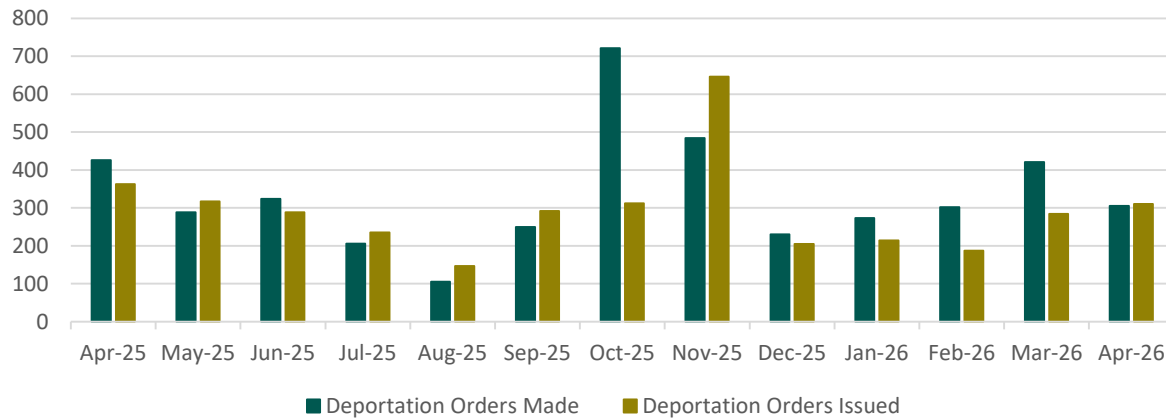
# International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused



- In April 2026, of those applications where a final decision was made (for example, after taking into account appeals), 410 were given refugee status grant and 71 subsidiary protection grant (481 in total). There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- Of those who were refused refugee status and subsidiary protection, 1 were given Permission to Remain on humanitarian grounds with 2 on a Permission to Remain Review Grant. There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- There were 558 refusals for International Protection Statuses and 315 for Permission to Remain Review
- Overall, for April 2026, 53% of decisions were refusals, 0% permission to remain, and 47% were international protection grants

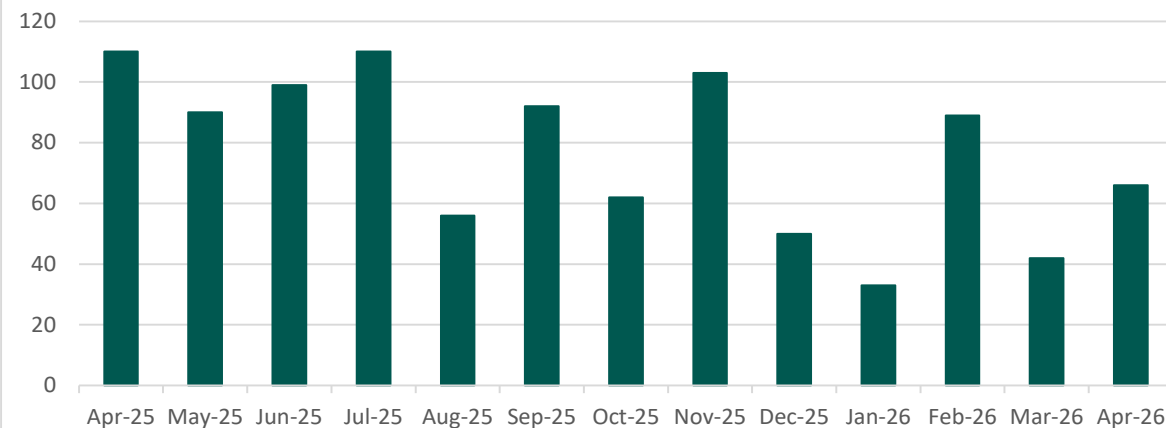
# Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

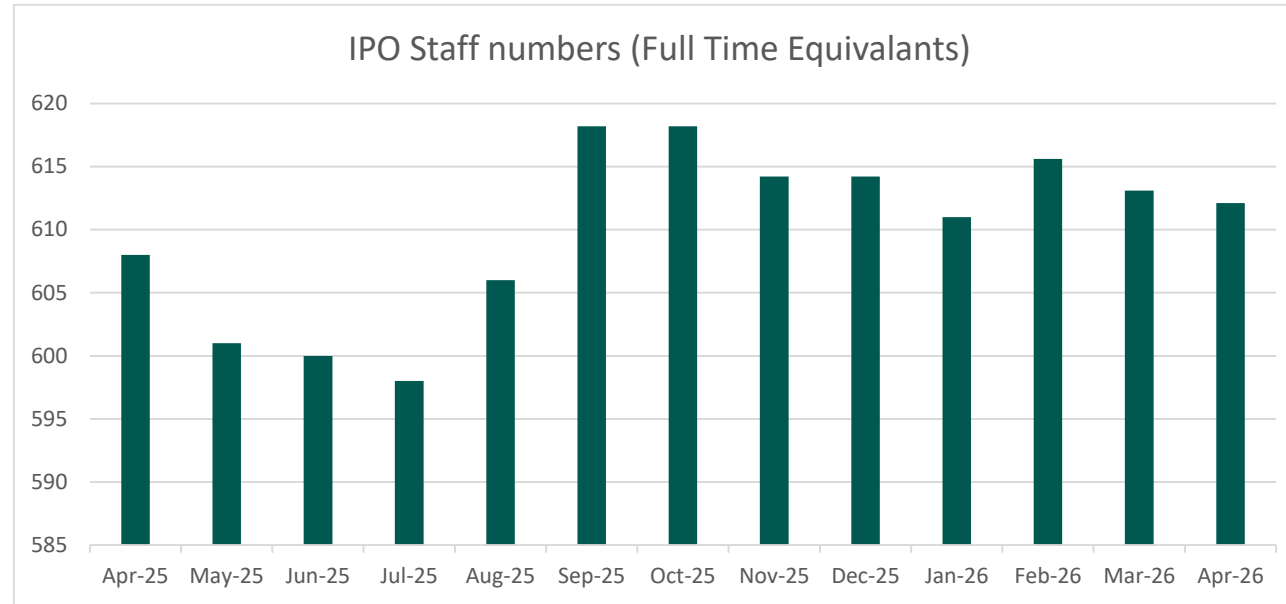


- For April 2026 the number of deportation orders made/signed (where a person had a previous asylum application) was 305 and the number of deportation orders issued was 310. For March, the figures were 421 and 284, and for February, the figures were 302 and 187, respectively
- For April 2026 the number of removals was 66

Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application



# IPO Staff number (Full-Time Equivalents)



- The number of staff in the IPO has started levelling off
- In April 2025 there were 608 FTEs in IPO. This number has been generally trending upwards with some fluctuations, to 615.6 in February and 613.1 in March 2026.
- At the end of April 2026, the IPO had 612.1 FTE staff



# Appendix

# Methodology

## Pending International Protection Applications

- IPO – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- IPAT – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- MDU – Data sourced from AISIP. Pending figure does not include legacy cases – the legacy data has been captured in such a way that it cannot be accurately reported on

## International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes

## International Protection Applications Processing Times

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- Applicants to whom section 38(5) of the International Protection Act 2015 applies (failure to co-operate) are included in the calculations
- Where an interview took place after a case was reactivated the reactivation date is used as the application date, otherwise the original application date was used for the processing time calculation
- The median calculation is used for processing time at IPO as there are significant outliers in the length of time asylum applications can spend in processing. This is typically due to lengthy procedures such as judicial reviews which are complex and time consuming by their nature, and which are also outside of the remit and control of the IPO during that part of the process. The median is a more accurate measure of the time spent by the IPO in processing applications.

# Methodology

## International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused

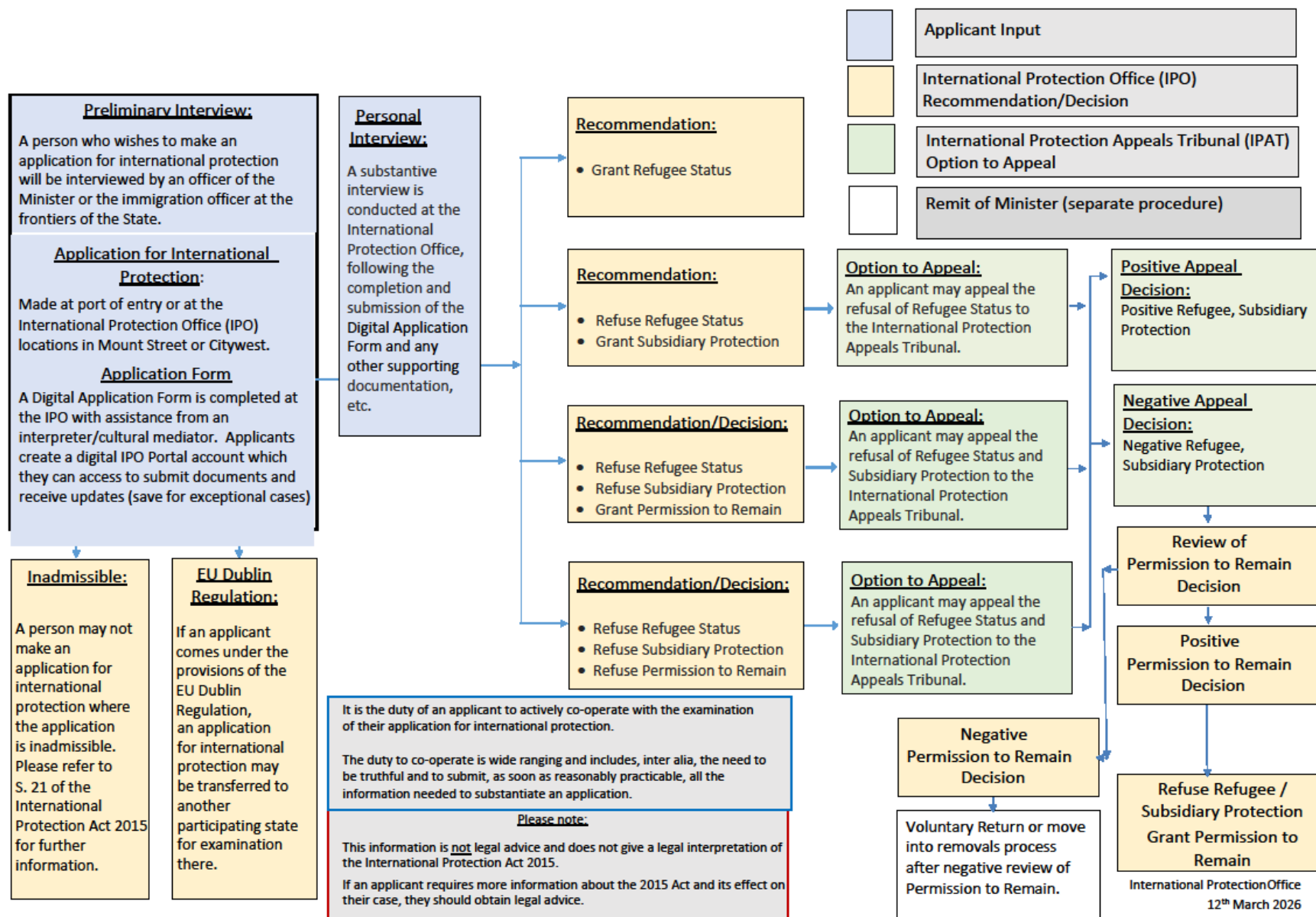
- Quashed decisions and Revocation of Status are not included
- Decision figures include international protection decisions (IPDN) and legacy application types
- Each applicant is represented once in the granted and refused tables
  - For example, if a person is refused refugee status but is granted subsidiary protection they are recorded once in the tables as a subsidiary protection grant. This is to more clearly represent the overall numbers of granted and refused applicants, and to avoid double counting of individuals where they are refused one type of status but are granted another.
- Some of the applicants who have been granted permission to remain are also included in the 'Refuse All International Protection Statuses' category of the refusals table. Permission to remain is a humanitarian permission. In order to be considered for permission to remain you must first have been refused international protection. On slide 7, the 'International Protection Refusals Granted Permission to Remain on Humanitarian Grounds' chart is a combination of applicants still in the asylum process and applicants who have finished the process. The 'International Protection Refusals' chart includes only those applicants who have finished the asylum process.
- Where a revocation occurs the original grant is removed from the figures for the month the permission was originally granted. For example, if an application was granted in January but subsequently revoked later in the year the January figure is updated to remove the grant

## Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

- Data for the International Protection Deportation Order (IPDP) application type is sourced from AISIP. All other data is sourced from Lotus Notes

# General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015

## General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015



# Data Tables (1)

## International Protection Office - Applications Received

|                       | Apr-25 | May-25 | Jun-25 | Jul-25 | Aug-25 | Sep-25 | Oct-25 | Nov-25 | Dec-25 | Jan-26 | Feb-26 | Mar-26 | Apr-26 |
|-----------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Accelerated Procedure | 327    | 333    | 285    | 344    | 440    | 589    | 519    | 400    | 549    | 397    | 375    | 368    | 383    |
| Standard Cases        | 746    | 608    | 716    | 821    | 610    | 737    | 704    | 694    | 707    | 726    | 645    | 555    | 689    |

## International Protection Office – Top 5 Nationality Applications

| Top 5 nationalities 2026 to date | Applications | %     |
|----------------------------------|--------------|-------|
| Somalia                          | 904          | 21.8% |
| Nigeria                          | 575          | 13.9% |
| Pakistan                         | 427          | 10.3% |
| Afghanistan                      | 352          | 8.5%  |
| Georgia                          | 263          | 6.4%  |
| Other                            | 1617         | 39.1% |
| Total                            | 4138         |       |

## Data Tables (2)

### International Protection Office - Pending Applications

| IPO Pending | Apr-25 | May-25 | Jun-25 | Jul-25 | Aug-25 | Sep-25 | Oct-25 | Nov-25 | Dec-25 | Jan-26 | Feb-26 | Mar-26 | Apr-26 |
|-------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| IP Pending  | 20,122 | 19,551 | 18,922 | 18,323 | 17,676 | 17,021 | 16,402 | 15,620 | 15,315 | 14,741 | 14,332 | 13,691 | 13,194 |
| Leg Pending | 0      | 0      | 0      | 0      | 0      | 0      | 0      | 0      | 0      | 0      | 0      | 0      | 0      |

### International Protection Appeals Tribunal - Pending Applications

|              | Apr-25 | May-25 | Jun-25 | Jul-25 | Aug-25 | Sep-25 | Oct-25 | Nov-25 | Dec-25 | Jan-26 | Feb-26 | Mar-26 | Apr-26 |
|--------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| IPAT Pending | 12,517 | 13,393 | 14,035 | 14,529 | 15,397 | 16,067 | 16,958 | 17,579 | 18,243 | 19,076 | 19,570 | 19,969 | 20,469 |

### Ministerial Decisions Unit - Pending Applications

| MDU Pending | Apr-25 | May-25 | Jun-25 | Jul-25 | Aug-25 | Sep-25 | Oct-25 | Nov-25 | Dec-25 | Jan-26 | Feb-26 | Mar-26 | Apr-26 |
|-------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Total       | 168    | 123    | 95     | 119    | 101    | 152    | 73     | 68     | 85     | 69     | 67     | 50     | 84     |

## Data Tables (3)

### International Protection Office – Processed Cases

|                               | Apr-25 | May-25 | Jun-25 | Jul-25 | Aug-25 | Sep-25 | Oct-25 | Nov-25 | Dec-25 | Jan-26 | Feb-26 | Mar-26 | Apr-26 |
|-------------------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Recommendation Made           | 1520   | 1451   | 1551   | 1697   | 1587   | 1870   | 1739   | 1774   | 1290   | 1606   | 1347   | 1509   | 1547   |
| Application Withdrawn         | 43     | 41     | 31     | 40     | 40     | 40     | 51     | 41     | 29     | 25     | 25     | 19     | 42     |
| Inadmissible Cases            | 31     | 31     | 27     | 29     | 40     | 28     | 24     | 39     | 41     | 50     | 37     | 42     | 21     |
| Applications Closed - Dormant | 0      | 0      | 0      | 0      | 0      | 0      | 0      | 4      | 157    | 0      | 30     | 0      | 0      |

### International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to IPO Determination (measured in weeks)

|                       | Apr-25 | May-25 | Jun-25 | Jul-25 | Aug-25 | Sep-25 | Oct-25 | Nov-25 | Dec-25 | Jan-26 | Feb-26 | Mar-26 | Apr-26 |
|-----------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Accelerated Procedure | 19     | 18     | 21     | 15     | 13     | 19     | 9      | 9      | 10     | 14     | 14     | 9      | 8      |
| Standard Cases        | 73     | 71     | 71     | 67     | 74     | 75     | 76     | 76     | 75     | 75     | 79     | 68     | 65     |

# Data Tables (4)

## International Protection Decisions – Grants

|                                   | Apr-25 | May-25 | Jun-25 | Jul-25 | Aug-25 | Sep-25 | Oct-25 | Nov-25 | Dec-25 | Jan-26 | Feb-26 | Mar-26 | Apr-26 |
|-----------------------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Refugee Status Grant              | 374    | 382    | 413    | 343    | 374    | 379    | 420    | 367    | 382    | 358    | 297    | 341    | 410    |
| Subsidiary Protection Grant       | 40     | 58     | 32     | 43     | 18     | 28     | 44     | 26     | 27     | 100    | 22     | 35     | 71     |
| Permission To Remain Grant        | 28     | 19     | 24     | 19     | 28     | 12     | 14     | 20     | 20     | 9      | 7      | 8      | 1      |
| Permission To Remain Review Grant | 10     | 6      | 10     | 4      | 4      | 4      | 9      | 28     | 15     | 10     | 10     | 2      | 2      |

## International Protection Decisions – Refusals

|                                              | Apr-25 | May-25 | Jun-25 | Jul-25 | Aug-25 | Sep-25 | Oct-25 | Nov-25 | Dec-25 | Jan-26 | Feb-26 | Mar-26 | Apr-26 |
|----------------------------------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Refuse All International Protection Statuses | 376    | 488    | 422    | 575    | 527    | 515    | 689    | 535    | 392    | 719    | 535    | 554    | 558    |
| Permission To Remain Review Refusal          | 178    | 201    | 232    | 294    | 184    | 247    | 310    | 267    | 232    | 264    | 236    | 252    | 315    |

## Data Tables (5)

### Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

|                           | Apr-25 | May-25 | Jun-25 | Jul-25 | Aug-25 | Sep-25 | Oct-25 | Nov-25 | Dec-25 | Jan-26 | Feb-26 | Mar-26 | Apr-26 |
|---------------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Deportation Orders Made   | 426    | 288    | 324    | 206    | 105    | 250    | 721    | 484    | 230    | 273    | 302    | 421    | 305    |
| Deportation Orders Issued | 363    | 317    | 288    | 235    | 147    | 292    | 312    | 646    | 205    | 214    | 187    | 284    | 310    |

### Deportation Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application

| Enforcements/Returns | Apr-25 | May-25 | Jun-25 | Jul-25 | Aug-25 | Sep-25 | Oct-25 | Nov-25 | Dec-25 | Jan-26 | Feb-26 | Mar-26 | Apr-26 |
|----------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Total                | 110    | 90     | 99     | 110    | 56     | 92     | 62     | 103    | 50     | 33     | 89     | 42     | 66     |

# Data Tables (6)

International Protection Office Staff Numbers (Full-Time Equivalents)

|                     | Apr-25 | May-25 | Jun-25 | Jul-25 | Aug-25 | Sep-25 | Oct-25 | Nov-25 | Dec-25 | Jan-26 | Feb-26 | Mar-26 | Apr-26 |
|---------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| IPO Staffing Levels | 608    | 601    | 600    | 598    | 606    | 618.2  | 618.2  | 614.2  | 614.2  | 611    | 615.6  | 613.1  | 612.1  |